Coping with Rejection

Hypnosis Script

Coping with Rejection

As you drift deeper into hypnosis, I'm going to be talking to you about how to cope with being rejected, as I know this is something that has been bothering you.

When someone is rejected, they feel pain – it really can hurt.

Whether that rejection is a job you didn't get, being turned down by someone you wanted to date, being ignored by a friend, or not being included in something you wanted to be included in, everyone has experienced rejection at some stage of their life.

We feel rejected when we're not included, accepted, or approved of because it is human nature to want to get along with others.

Rejection involves the loss of something that we had, or that we wanted, that is no longer available to us, and it can feel as though we've been abandoned, are unwanted or not good enough.

It can feel like being karate kicked in the heart.

Quite often, people who were repeatedly rejected as a child grow up believing they are inadequate, and this false belief can add to the pain of being rejected.

Such people come to expect rejection in every area of their lives.

So, the first thing I want you to do is to go back in your mind now: remember your childhood and a time when you were rejected for something that made you

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upset.

Just about everyone has experienced rejection at some point in their lives – but some of these experiences stick like superglue and damage our future emotions.

You may need to go back to when you were somewhere between the ages of three and eight years old or perhaps even earlier.

Just let your mind wander gently back in time, sifting carefully through the memories of the past as though there is no such thing as time.

So, let your mind travel back now - and see or feel or experience or simply sense yourself becoming smaller and younger; younger and smaller.

Short pause.

It may feel as though you are swirling through a long dark tunnel or travelling over the bridge of time.

You might experience yourself on a vast beach with the ocean before you and the sands of time to the left and the right, representing your past and your future.

Whichever method you decide, just allow yourself to drift gently back and signal yes to me when you are there as that young child again.

Wait for a signal.

Good, now visualize yourself watching a huge screen with a movie being shown on it.

I want you to reflect on this time in your childhood when you felt rejected.

What had you been doing? What were you rejected for? What happened afterwards?

What did the person who rejected you do?

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Short pause.

I want you to observe everything that happened through the eyes of an observer.

Perhaps you wondered why you were rejected, so let's explore some possible scenarios and reasons.

Maybe you felt rejected when a teacher didn't choose your piece of work to be on display, even though you had spent what felt like hours and hours working on it.

In reality, there were probably twenty-nine other children competing against you, and your teacher wasn't able to choose you all.

And they never noticed the look of disappointment on your face, or if they did, they didn't think you'd take it so personally.

Short pause.

Perhaps a relative chose a sibling to ride with on a ride with them over you and made you sit on your own.

They could only choose any one of you, but I'm sure they had their reasons; perhaps your sibling needed more adult guidance than you, or perhaps they were chosen at random. Either way, it wasn't your fault: it was just one of those things that happened.

Perhaps when you were in a swimming lesson and the teacher was handing out floats, and they reached you at the end of the line just as time ran out.

You felt upset and rejected because you didn't get a float, but, in reality, the teacher messed up and hadn't brought enough floats.

Your teacher should have found more, rather than leaving you feeling that way, but there could be so many reasons why they didn't or weren't able to, and it certainly was not your fault.

Your teacher was probably over-worked and stressed, or simply forgot.

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Short pause.

Perhaps your rejection was more serious, and an adult chose to do something or meet someone else instead of spending quality time with you.

Although it would have felt personal at the time, there could have been all sorts of reasons that you weren't aware of at the time, but it was not your fault.

You were just a child – you deserved to be loved whatever you did.

Nothing you could have done or said would have made a difference, and in fairness, you have no idea what was going on in that adult's life, so no one is really to blame.

Your feelings of rejection could stem from something totally different, something I haven't even mentioned yet.

Short pause.

And your subconscious mind is sifting through your memories, identifying situations, and remembering situations that led to your feelings of rejection.

Short pause.

As you continue to look at the screen, I want you to focus on the child that you were, rather than the events that led to your unwanted feelings.

See yourself as you were at the time; a small child who felt disconnected and lost from those around you.

Now project the image of yourself as you are now; a well-adjusted adult who survived those feelings and is here to help, love and nurture your inner child and show it the way.

Step into the screen and hold the hand of your inner child.

Explain to your inner child that you know those feelings of rejection caused them pain; pain that would stay with them until this session today and have a profound impact on their life, until now.

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Tell your inner child that you understand why they feel as they do.

Short pause.

Perhaps your inner child is in tears, having bottled up those feelings of rejection, but I want you to hug and reassure them that everything is going to be okay.

You are here for them and will look out for your inner child from this moment forward.

Short pause.

Maybe you will explain that any rejection was random and had no bearing on whether they were good enough or not.

Or you can explain that the adult made the best choice they could at the time.

Your reassurance and explanations will depend on whatever the situations were at the time, so you can trust your subconscious mind to say the words that your child needs to hear.

So, explain whatever needs to be said to make your inner child feel better and help it to get on with the rest of its life without letting those past experiences have a negative effect.

Short pause.

This child lives in your soul – it is you from yesteryear – and you finally realise that any rejections you felt in your past were not of your making; they were not your fault.

Yes, they were hard at the time, but they happened, and you are now ready to put them aside to make peace with yourself.

And as this realization dawns upon you, you now know that, if in the future you ever experience any feelings of rejection again, you will be able to cope with those feelings so much more easily.

And your ability to cope more easily means that you no longer need to suppress

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your feelings.

Short pause.

You may have lost something or someone you had hoped to keep, but there is always something better around the corner, and this gives you an opportunity to explore other options.

If it ***is*** something you really wanted, then it's okay to feel sad for a short while and even explore the reasons for the rejection, providing you do so with the aim of learning something of importance from the experience.

You can set a timescale of how long you will experience any sadness – you might say to yourself, 'I'm disappointed this didn't work out, but I will only be sad for two hours and after that, I am going to give myself a chance to learn or understand something of value to me.'

It's only natural to want to know why and it's okay to ask for feedback from someone who has let you down, but deep inside, you know from your reassuring inner child that there aren't always clear reasons for rejection,

When we humans don't have answers, we tend to blame ourselves; we assume that we messed up, we weren't enough, that we were unlovable, difficult, stupid, and so on, but you know that those thoughts are wrong.

Short pause.

You may have been conditioned from an early age to believe that you were inadequate and to blame for being rejected.

Those are beliefs that you can now choose to discard because you know that that child inside of you wasn't to blame.

As an adult, you are better equipped to consider alternative hypotheses - other reasons for rejection.

There are so many possible reasons, and even the most attractive, intelligent, accomplished, and charming people get rejected.

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You may have failed to get the job you'd applied for because the manager decided to hire a relative or person who already worked for the company, or perhaps a potential date didn't call you back because they felt insecure or inadequate.

Perhaps the person who rejected your work was forgetful or got distracted, or didn't have the time to take a good look at it.

Know, too, that it is not always about you, and it's unfair to blame yourself or take responsibility for things that were out of your control or to wrongly assume you were at fault.

Did you know some of the most successful people in life have been rejected many times in their given field before realising their dream or achieving success?

For example, runners-up on talent shows often become more successful than the winners.

There are many writers and artists who had their work rejected repeatedly; J.K. Rowling submitted Harry Potter to twelve publishers who all rejected her novels, before one accepted it, making it one of the most famous pieces of fiction ever written.

William Golding's Lord of the Flies was rejected twenty times before it was accepted for publication.

Moby-Dick was rejected by multiple publishers, To Kill a Mockingbird was rejected ten times, Ann Frank's Diary had fifteen rejections, and Dr. Seuss had a long list of rejected books.

However, the authors of these great works didn't take their rejection personally; instead, they accepted that it was a normal and necessary process on the path to getting their work published.

They persevered and kept submitting their work until one day, an editor realised their potential and saw how amazing their work was and agreed to go ahead with the publication, after which they became best sellers.

Short pause.

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So, when you receive feedback on rejections, be selective about the criticism that you take on board.

If you receive highly negative and mean comments, don't take them personally, as it could say more about the person making the comments than the person they were directed at.

On the other hand, if you receive criticism that is constructive and you feel might hold more than a few grains of truth, listen carefully to it to see if there are any lessons that you can take from the feedback.

If the feedback says that you are doing something wrong, see where adjustments can be made and, if appropriate, alter whatever you did wrong.

Remind yourself why it is you want what you want.

In the past, when you were rejected, it was as though there was a hole in your life, but you now see that you can easily fill that hole, perhaps with something or someone slightly different to what you originally envisaged.

But who knows how things will turn out? Life is full of surprises, and none of us knows what is around the corner.

If you don't get over the initial rejection and try again, there will always be a small gap in your life, so surprise yourself.

Feel sad for two hours, if you must, then reflect on possible reasons for the rejection or ask for feedback to help you to improve whatever it is that you do.

If change is required, reconnect with your inner child, and focus on making positive changes to your life.

See this time as an opportunity to explore and have fun and surprise yourself by doing something different.

Instead of focusing on the word fail, remind yourself that the word stands for:

Forever Acquiring Important Learnings

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And these learnings are far more important to you than any negative feelings.

This thought inspires you to revisit your aspirations; perhaps check that they are still what you want and find ways of improving whatever it is that you do.

Short pause.

As you find yourself having more fun, you also begin to explore opportunities that come your way and, if appropriate, explore different approaches.

Your subconscious mind is committed to helping you to overcome any feelings of rejection, and your inner child is waiting to play.

In a few moments, I am going to count the numbers from one to five to bring you out of hypnosis, and when you return to normal conscious awareness, you will find that rejection no longer bothers you.

And you can be really curious as to how you are going to surprise yourself by reacting and doing things in a totally different way.

I will now count the numbers from one to five, and at the count of five, you will be wide awake, fully alert, and wonderfully refreshed and ready to allow these suggestions to work for you.

So, get ready now as I count up.

One, start coming slowly back.

Two, your body is beginning to feel lighter.

Three, your mind is beginning to feel calmer and happier.

Four, you are becoming more alert and aware of your surroundings.

And five, you are wide awake, refreshed and alert and ready to allow these suggestions to work for you.

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